

Smart supermarket food swaps to cut calories and get lean

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 29, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/9ly-2xhHcbs> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter gives five practical supermarket swaps — trading calorie-dense staples for leaner alternatives — so you can keep eating satisfying, real food while staying in a caloric deficit.

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Swap 1: Chicken Tenders → Rotisserie Chicken [0:00](#)

- Instead of grabbing pre-made chicken tenders, head to the meat section for rotisserie chicken
 - Key selling point: it's already cooked — no prep needed, same convenience as tenders
 - To cut calories even further, skip eating the skin
 - The skin is where a significant portion of the fat and extra calories sit

Swap 2: Ribeye Steak → Sirloin Steak [0:22](#)

- Ribeye is acknowledged as delicious but is flagged as too calorie-heavy when cutting
- Sirloin is typically stocked right next to ribeye in the meat aisle
 - It's **significantly leaner** and lower in calories than ribeye
 - You still get to eat steak for dinner — the swap doesn't feel like deprivation

Swap 3: Bacon → Turkey Bacon [0:22](#)

- Regular bacon is high in fat and calories
- Turkey bacon is the direct swap
 - Brandon openly admits it's "not as good" in taste
 - The payoff is meaningfully fewer calories, making it easier to stay in a deficit



Swap 4: Chicken Thighs → Chicken Breast 0:44

- Chicken thighs are described as "the most delicious part of the chicken"
 - However, they carry significantly more calories than chicken breast due to higher fat content
- Chicken breast is the leaner swap
 - Brandon is candid: "I hate chicken breasts with my whole heart. I think they're gross."
 - Despite personal distaste, he eats them when cutting because the calorie difference matters



Swap 5: Avocado → Leafy Greens 0:44

- Avocados are called out as both delicious and nutritious — but **calorically dense**
 - When cutting, caloric density is the problem, even with healthy foods
- The swap is to reach for greens (salad leaves, spinach, etc.) instead
 - Greens let you eat a filling volume of food without a significant calorie cost
 - The goal is to feel full on something that doesn't eat into your calorie budget